

UrbanHeat AI

Al Khor area study, Qatar

Theme: Urban Expansion, Land Use Change & Heat Risk

Satellite and local evidence for heat-protection site assessments

Team Al Zubarah, Qatar

UAE Space Academy hackathon, October 2026

The planning problem

Find hot cells, then check who uses them and when.

Satellite screening helps organise visits; local review adds context about shade, access and planned use.

Human exposure has not been measured. Trees, shelters and safer routes are options to assess.

The prototype supports investigation; it does not establish heat-health risk.

Bus-stop site assessment: V04-23

Satellite: 50.4 °C mean of two cell medians; 0% detected green pixels at the current threshold.

Local evidence: roadside trees, no shelter and limited walking access; Nasser confirms site visits.

Next check: waiting-time shade, passenger use, route safety, ownership and feasibility.

300 m values are not stop measurements. Nasser confirms unchanged physical conditions; visit dates unspecified.

Open satellite data and mapped context

Sentinel-2: green-pixel indicators from 5, 15 and 30 September 2026.

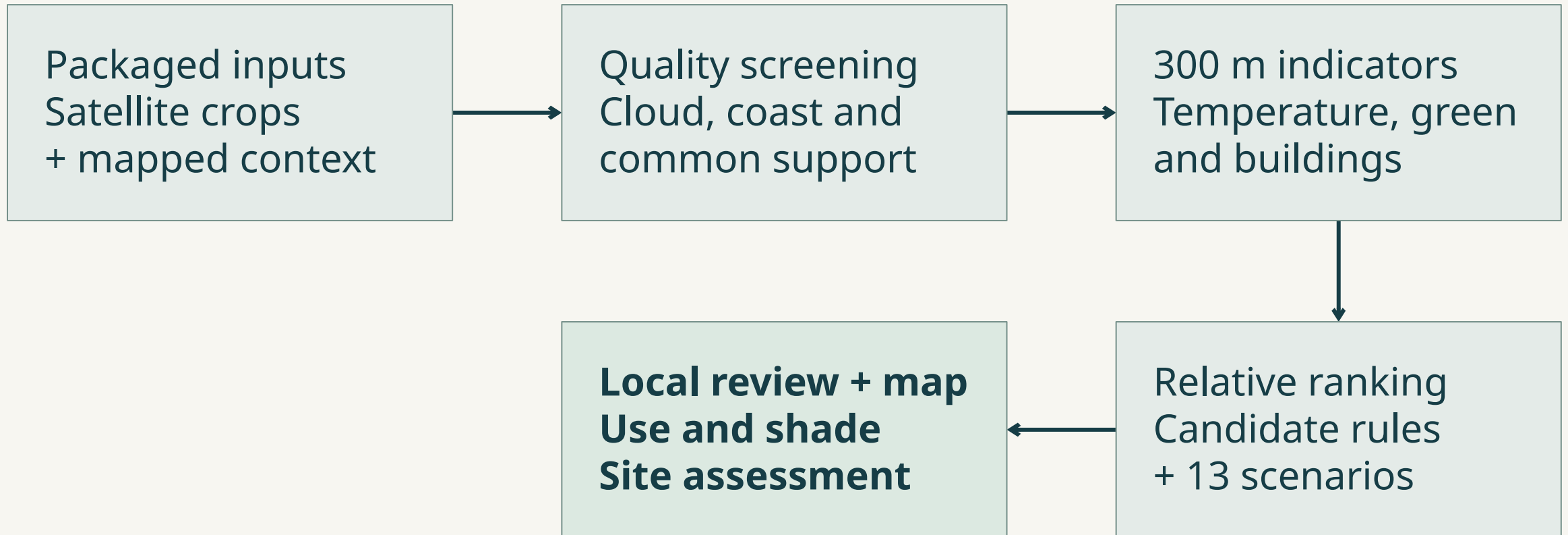
Landsat: surface temperature from 14 and 30 September. The 6 September scene fails coverage QA.

WorldCover 2021: historical land-cover context. OpenStreetMap: contributed building footprints downloaded 5 October.

No hyperspectral, 813 or proprietary VHR data are used.

Thermal native detail is about 100 m, delivered on a 30 m grid. We report 300 m cells.

From source crops to an inspectable shortlist



External AI land cover: WorldCover for heat screening; Dynamic World in a separate experiment.
QA/ranking are rule based. No new model trained.

Al Khor presentation examples

Team-selected presentation examples; satellite ranking unchanged

V04-23 · Bus-stop road



V28-17 · Stadium parking



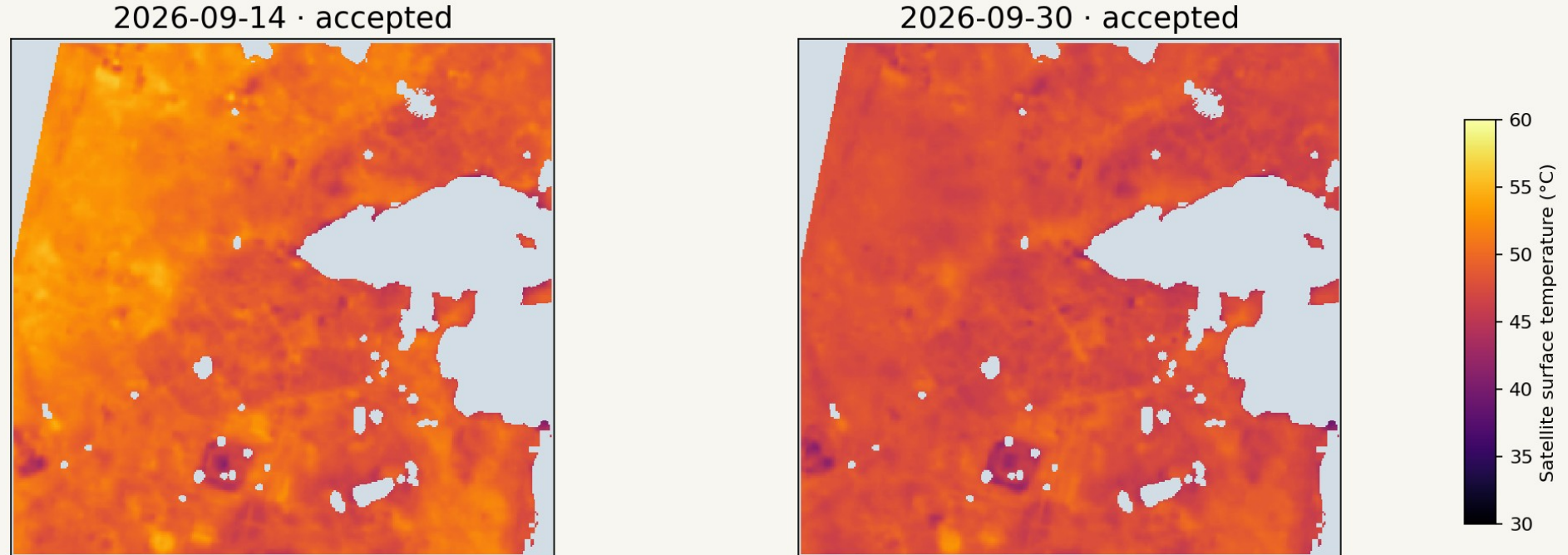
V18-26 · Reported jogging route



Existing September 2026 satellite context; no new photograph or surveyed route. Cell values are not point measurements.

Team-selected examples; all 1,111 observed cells and 373 candidates remain. The satellite top three are unchanged.

Matched surface-temperature observations



6 September excluded: 0% of historical urban inland support passed the strict filters.
94.4379 km² of common inland sample footprints. Grey: excluded or missing observations.

Morning surface observations, not air temperature. Native thermal detail about 100 m, delivered at 30 m.
Date differences do not establish long-term cooling. Landsat imagery courtesy of USGS.

94.4379 km² of common inland sample footprints across the broad study window.

Three examples for site investigation

Case study	Surface °C*	Green %*	Buildings %	Rank range
V04-23	50.4	0.0	2.3	1-14
V28-17	50.0	0.0	0.1	1-23
V18-26	47.47	0.0386	0.0	203–336

Bus stop: waiting-area shade. Stadium: event use. Jogging route: reported lack of path shade; dated evidence pending.

Team-selected examples, not the top three ranks. V18-26 ranks 275/373; hospital land stays in the full results. Visits do not measure use or shade.

*Means of date-level cell summaries. V18-26: 48.02/46.92°C; 72% coverage. Scenario ranges are not confidence intervals.

Reproducibility and reference checks

The package includes 35 hashed input files, source metadata and pinned Python 3.12 dependencies.

Clean GitHub execution passed through a normal Jupyter kernel: five cells, zero errors and all 35 input hashes verified.

NDVI ≥ 0.30 at 24/25 grass references and 0/30 building references. All 30 coastal references are excluded from retained thermal support.

Contributed reference labels have conflicts. Human confirmation and independent thermal validation remain pending.

Potential impact and incubation next steps

Completed: satellite screening, sensitivity checks, local examples and assistant review of 18 sites across four dates.

Next: detailed shade, use and access checks plus planner feedback; evaluate inspection decisions.

Limited Dynamic World experiment: common coverage 30.94% (50% gate). Independent scientific validation pending; 2023 deferred.

The current PoC does not measure urban expansion, health risk, causal cooling or long-term warming.

Team responsibilities

Nasser Alhuri: team coordination, site-visit confirmation and submission.

Abdulrahman Almohannadi: review the project; collect dated photographs and local observations.

Mohammed Almarri: practise the presentation and explain the project.

Majed Alkuwari: review slides and explain the limitations.

Ali Alkubaisi: demonstrate the project and prepare judge questions.

Original site visits confirmed; photographs, detailed assessment and member reviews/rehearsals remain pending.

Data attribution and sources

Actual sources: Copernicus Sentinel, Landsat (USGS), WorldCover 2021, OSM; separate experimental Dynamic World exports (2021, 2026).

Credits: modified Copernicus Sentinel data (2026); Landsat courtesy USGS; WorldCover CC BY 4.0; OSM ODbL.

Dynamic World, CC BY 4.0: This dataset is produced for the Dynamic World Project by Google in partnership with National Geographic Society and the World Resources Institute.

Modified Copernicus Sentinel data (2021, 2026). Full sources, licences and experimental limits accompany the package. Code: MIT.